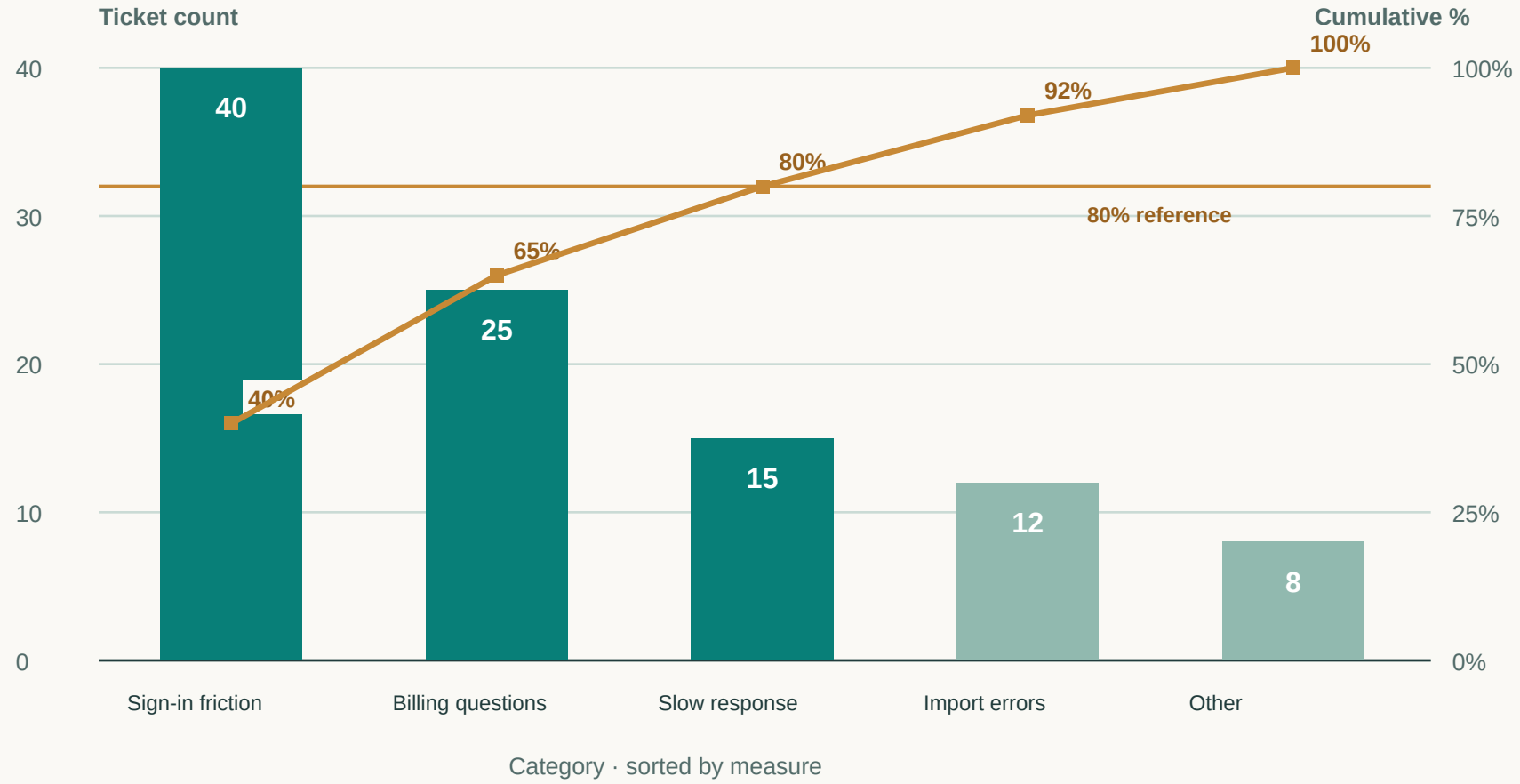
Find where the volume concentrates

Pareto analysis · Fictional support-ticket example · Priority still needs judgment.



Bars: measure (left) · Line: cumulative % (right) · Total: 100

Fictional example

Read the pattern

First three categories account for 80.0% of total measure. The 80% line is a reference, not a universal law.

Before prioritizing

Check severity and effort.
Check sample + time window.
Ask what is preventable.

Decision: _____

Owner / test: _____

Original Stylus Nexus artwork · MIT · Working template: replace prompts with evidence.

Read the pressures around an industry

Porter's Five Forces · Define the industry and geography before judging competitive pressure.

Threat of new entrants

Entry barriers, scale, switching costs?

Evidence: _____ Pressure: ____

Supplier bargaining power

Concentration? Unique inputs?

Switching costs? Evidence: _____

Rivalry among existing firms

Growth, differentiation, exit barriers?

Industry boundary: _____

Buyer bargaining power

Concentration? Price sensitivity?

Alternatives? Evidence: _____

Threat of substitutes

Other ways to meet the same need?

Price / performance? Switching ease?

WORKSHOP QUESTION

Which pressure changes our choices?

Response: _____

Framework: Michael E. Porter

Assess evidence, direction and timing.

High / medium / low is a discussion aid.

Original Stylus Nexus artwork · MIT · Working template: replace prompts with evidence.

Sequence outcomes, then commit to learning

Now / Next / Later · Horizons express confidence and sequence, not promised delivery dates.

NOW

Act + measure

Outcome: _____

Baseline > target: _____

Smallest bet: _____

Owner / review: _____

NEXT

Prepare + validate

Outcome: _____

What must be true? _____

Evidence to advance: _____

Dependency: _____

LATER

Explore + preserve options

Opportunity: _____

Why it matters: _____

Signal to revisit: _____

What we will not promise: ____

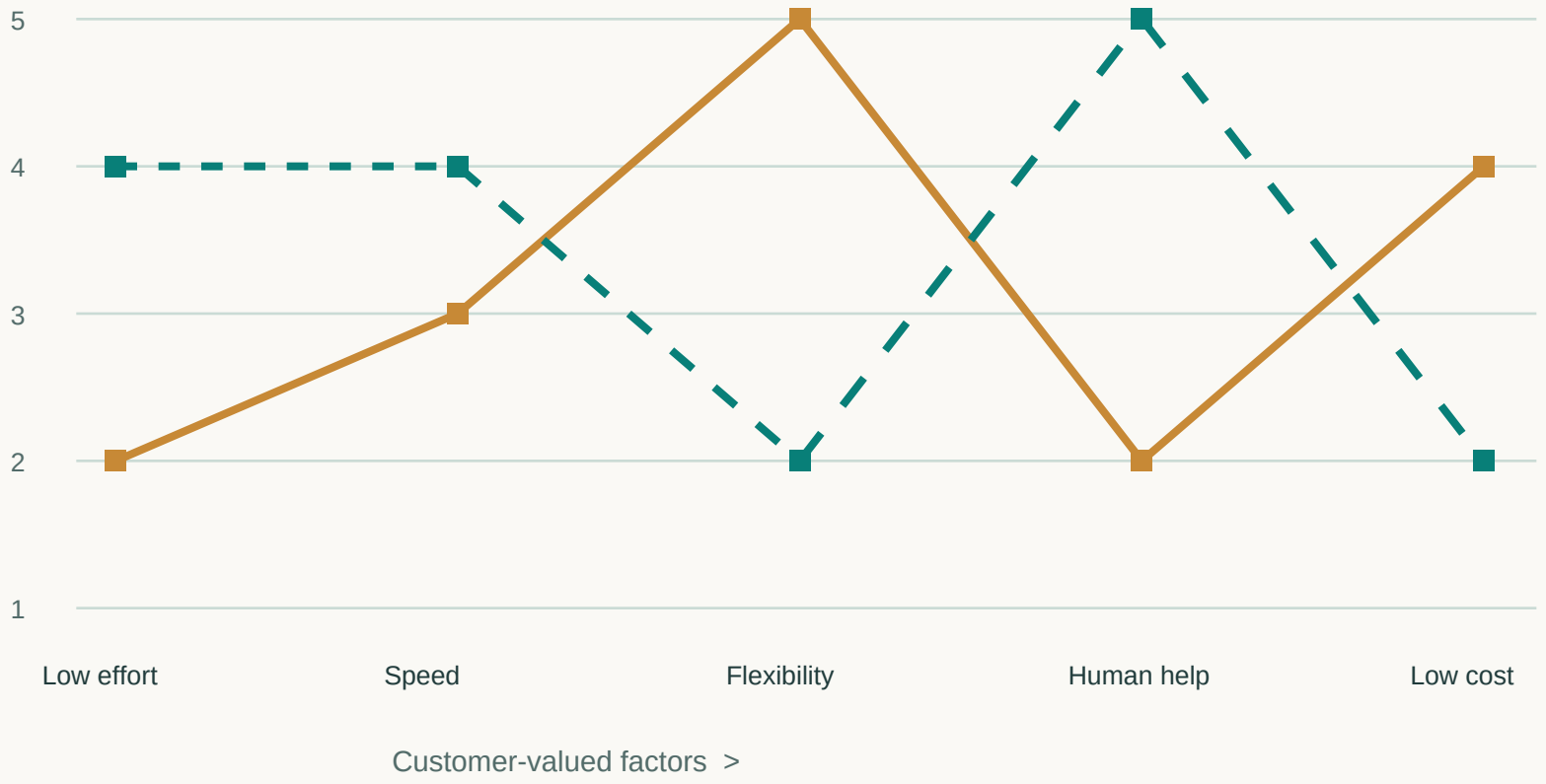
Decision at review: continue / change / stop · Link each bet to an outcome and current evidence.

Original Stylus Nexus artwork · MIT · Working template: replace prompts with evidence.

Make differences in value explicit

Illustrative strategy profile · Fictional relative scores; validate with your chosen customer segment.

Relative offering level · 1 low, 5 high



Compare deliberately

Dashed teal: proposed offer

Solid gold: current alternative

Segment: _____

Basis of score: _____

Choose the trade-offs

Eliminate: _____

Reduce: _____

Raise: _____

Create: _____

Test value, not just difference.

Original Stylus Nexus artwork · MIT · Working template: replace prompts with evidence.

Test the assumptions that can break the plan

Map one claim per note · Importance means impact if false; evidence means relevant, reliable support.

High importance ^

TEST FIRST H1: [segment] will change behavior because [benefit] matters enough.	**MONITOR + PROTECT**
EXPLORE CHEAPLY	**DEFER**

Little evidence — Strong evidence >

Low importance at bottom · Move notes only when new evidence warrants it.

Plan a test

Claim ID: _____

Smallest test:

_____

Decision threshold:

_____

Owner / date:

_____

Original Stylus Nexus artwork · MIT · Working template: replace prompts with evidence.

Follow the job through the customer's eyes

Define one segment + scenario · Separate observed evidence from hypotheses and team ideas.

	Trigger	Explore	Choose	Use	Continue
Customer goal	What progress?	What progress?	What progress?	What progress?	What progress?
Action + touchpoint	What happens?	What happens?	What happens?	What happens?	What happens?
Friction / emotion	Where is the effort?	Where is the effort?	Where is the effort?	Where is the effort?	Where is the effort?
Evidence	Source / unknown	Source / unknown	Source / unknown	Source / unknown	Source / unknown
Opportunity	Next test / owner	Next test / owner	Next test / owner	Next test / owner	Next test / owner

Scenario: _____ Segment: _____ Interview / source: _____

Original Stylus Nexus artwork · MIT · Working template: replace prompts with evidence.

Product Strategy Canvas

Product / owner: _____ Segment: _____ Date / status: _____

Vision

Future worth creating

Values that shape choices

Choice: _____

Evidence: _____

Market Segments

Jobs + chosen context

Who are we excluding?

Choice: _____

Evidence: _____

Relative Costs

Advantage + cost drivers

Broad or focused scope?

Choice: _____

Evidence: _____

Value Proposition

Before > how > after

Alternative + difference

Choice: _____

Evidence: _____

Trade-offs

What we decline + why

Sacrifice + revisit trigger

Choice: _____

Evidence: _____

Key Metrics

Outcome + guardrail

Baseline / target / source

Choice: _____

Evidence: _____

Growth

Channels + growth motion

Retention logic + evidence

Choice: _____

Evidence: _____

Capabilities

Abilities + resources

Current gaps + partners

Choice: _____

Evidence: _____

Can’t / Won’t

Who could copy us?

Barriers + incentive conflicts

Choice: _____

Evidence: _____

Ask Yourself

Do choices reinforce?

Tensions + what must be true

Choice: _____

Evidence: _____

Consequential choice: _____ Riskiest assumption / test: _____

Owner: _____ Next review trigger: _____ Linked objective: _____

Adapted layout: Pawel Huryn / The Product Compass · Product Strategy Canvas v1.2 · CC BY-SA 4.0

Connect customer progress to a credible promise

Product: _____ Segment / context: _____ Decision: _____ Status: draft

01 Job / step

What progress matters?

When and for whom?

V1: _____

02 Existing situation

What happens today?

Cost / friction / consequence

V1: _____

03 Enabling capability

How does it work?

Why would behavior change?

V1: _____

04 Desired benefit

What becomes better?

Observable outcome

V1: _____

Alternatives + difference

Include workarounds and doing nothing.

Why would this segment switch?

Evidence + unknowns

Which link in V1 is supported?

Source / hypothesis / confidence:

Next test

What evidence would change the decision?

Owner / threshold / date:

Optional message: For [audience], achieve [benefit] through [understandable mechanism].

Link to V1 evidence. Test comprehension, relevance and credibility; test adoption and outcomes separately.

Adapted layout: Pawel Huryn / Product Compass + Aatir Abdul Rauf / Behind Product Lines · CC BY-SA 4.0